HACK876 × SANDALS FOUNDATION

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Every computer lab deserves a builder.

The Sandals Foundation has helped keep Jamaican school computer labs running. Hack876 gives secondary-school students one day to put that kind of technology to work on a real problem.

WHAT HACK876 IS

A one-day build competition in Kingston for about 80 secondary-school students, 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4. Teams pick a real problem and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges.

When: Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative)

Where: Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston (confirmed)

Who: About 80 students, roughly 20 teams

Organisers: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers



WHY THE SANDALS FOUNDATION

The Sandals Foundation names digital literacy as part of its education work, and has kept Jamaican school computer labs running with solar power.[2]

WHAT WE ARE ASKING

A Silver contribution from the Sandals Foundation toward the inaugural event.

Silver Partner: J$200,000 to below J$500,000. Any amount within the level is welcome.

WHAT IT MAKES POSSIBLE

Helps support the equipment teams build with and the student programme on the day.

WHAT THE SANDALS FOUNDATION RECEIVES

Silver recognition, including placement on event signage and acknowledgement in the opening and closing, and a written recap of who took part and what they built.

THE NEXT STEP

A reply on whether the Foundation would consider a contribution, at Silver or any other level, or whether this would need to come through its grant process.

Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · info@hack876.com

01 WHY THE SANDALS FOUNDATION

Technology in students' hands, and a group that backs education.

Hack876 is where secondary-school students put technology to work on a problem they care about, in one day.

Education is one of the Foundation's strategic focus areas, covering school infrastructure, teacher training, digital literacy and scholarships.[4]

The Foundation installed solar power at Hague Primary and Infant School and Cove Primary so that their computer labs keep running when the grid does not.[2]

In 2026 Sandals Resorts International, which funds the Foundation's governance, gave J$6 million to the Jill Stewart MoBay City Run, which has handed over J$45 million toward education since it began.[1]

WHAT THE FOUNDATION ALREADY BACKS

MOBAY CITY RUN · 2026

J$6 million for a run that funds education.

Announced by Adam Stewart, Executive Chairman, for the run's 10th staging.[1]

COMPUTER LABS

Solar power for school labs.

Solar systems at Hague Primary and Cove Primary keep their computer labs running. Hague also received 20 computers from the Foundation in 2024.[2]

DECEMBER 2021

Fifty tablets in Above Rocks.

Delivered with Rainforest to students at St Mary Primary School, based on a needs assessment.[3]

EDUCATION FOCUS

Digital literacy, by design.

Education is one of the Foundation's strategic focus areas, covering school infrastructure, teacher training, digital literacy and scholarships.[4]

02 OUR REQUEST

Become a Silver Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

SILVER PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

Silver helps support the technology and programme at the centre of the day. If a different level suits the Foundation better, any of them is welcome.

WHAT IT HELPS SUPPORT

- ✓ **Equipment.** Helps support the equipment teams build with.
- ✓ **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.
- ✓ **The event overall.** Used where it helps the students most.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

We understand the Foundation's project grants run through a two-stage annual cycle, which has closed for 2027, and that they exclude one-off events. This is a direct request for a single day. If the Foundation can only consider it through its grant process, we will follow that route.

WHAT THE SANDALS FOUNDATION WOULD RECEIVE

- ✓ **Everything in Bronze**
- ✓ **Placement on event signage**
- ✓ **Acknowledgement in the opening and closing**
- ✓ **A written recap after the event**

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner (SUGGESTED)	Gold Partner	Platinum Partner
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

03 DELIVERY AND NEXT DECISION

Who is running it, and what we need from you.

ORGANISERS	Nadani Dixon (Redfin) and Stefen Ewers (Georgia Tech) lead the event and are the contacts for this proposal.
VENUE	Spanish Court Hotel in Kingston is confirmed as the venue.
DATE	Saturday, February 20, 2027 is the working date. It is tentative until confirmed with schools.
JUDGES	7 judges have confirmed, from Tesla, Microsoft, Meta, Google, Accenture, Diageo, HashiCorp.

Schools: 1 confirmed, 2 in talks, 6 not yet confirmed, from a network of 9 in Kingston. Sponsors do not receive student contact details, and there are no sign-ups or selling on the day. Photos and names are used only with school and parent consent.

THE DECISION WE ARE ASKING FOR

A reply on whether the Foundation would consider a contribution, at Silver or any other level, or whether this would need to come through its grant process.

The Sandals Foundation lists foundation@grp.sandals.com and 876-935-0705 for enquiries.[6]

Your contact: Nadani Dixon and Stefen Ewers, Hack876 organisers · **info@hack876.com**

WHAT YOU WOULD RECEIVE AFTERWARDS: A WRITTEN RECAP

- ✓ **How many students, teams and schools took part**
- ✓ **What the teams built, with the finalist projects described**
- ✓ **How your contribution was used**
- ✓ **Photos, only where schools and parents have consented**

We will document the recognition delivered and report the results we have. Audience reach and commercial outcomes are not guaranteed. Student contact details are not shared.

Contribution levels, and what each receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement on the website and event signage
- A dedicated sponsor feature**
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- Everything in Gold
- The most prominent placement on the website and event signage

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

**The form of the sponsor feature is agreed with each Gold or Platinum partner before it is confirmed.

The judging panel decides every award. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

In-kind & Community Support: For contributions in kind, and for contributions below J$50,000. A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

SOURCES

1. Jamaica Observer, "Sandals pumps $6 million into 2026 staging of Jill Stewart MoBay City Run (March 11, 2026)." www.jamaicaobserver.com/2026/03/11/sandals-pumps-6-million-2026-staging-jill-stewart-mobay-city-run/

2. Caribbean360, "Sandals Foundation invests JMD $4M to bring solar power to Western Jamaica schools (2026)." caribbean360.com/sandals-foundation-invests-jmd-4m-to-bring-solar-power-to-western-jamaica-school

3. Sandals Foundation, "Sandals Foundation and Rainforest Open A New World of Learning for Vulnerable Primary School Students (December 2021)." sandalsfoundation.org/news/sandals-foundation-and-rainforest-open-a-new-world-of-learning-for-vulnerable-primary-school-students

4. Sandals Foundation, "Sandals Foundation 2027 Project Guidelines & Selection Criteria (July 2026)." sandalsfoundation.org/news/sandals-foundation-2027-project-guidelines-and-selection-criteria

5. Sandals Foundation, "Get Involved." sandalsfoundation.org/get-involved

6. Sandals Foundation, "Contact." sandalsfoundation.org/contact

A private partnership proposal prepared for the team at the Sandals Foundation.